

Lab 50 — Ticketing, Documentation and Knowledge Base Authoring

Course: CompTIA Certified A+ Training (Core 1 and Core 2) (TGS-2024048317)

Topic 09: Operational Procedures — Core 2, 21% of Core 2

Exam objective: Write support tickets and documentation to professional standard, and author a knowledge base article from a resolved incident (Core 2 objective 4.1).

Goal

A ticket is both the work record and the organisation's memory. You write a complete ticket from a real scenario, then convert it into the knowledge base article that stops the next technician re-solving the same problem from scratch.

What you'll produce

A completed support ticket meeting all required fields, and a knowledge base article derived from it.

Tools and equipment

Ticketing template, documentation standards reference, knowledge base template

Safety

- Disconnect mains power and hold the power button for 15 seconds before working inside any machine.
- Wear an anti-static strap connected to an earthed point; hold boards and cards by their edges.
- **Never open a power supply unit or a CRT monitor** — both retain a lethal charge after being unplugged.
- Never puncture, compress or charge a swollen lithium battery; isolate it and follow hazardous disposal procedure.

Step-by-step

1. List the required ticket fields: user information, device information, problem description, category, severity, escalation level, steps attempted, resolution and time spent.
2. Record the rule for the problem description: capture the user's own words for the symptom, then add your technical observation separately, so the two are never confused.
3. Define the severity levels and what distinguishes them: critical where business stops, high

where a team is blocked, medium where one user is blocked with a workaround, and low for a request or minor annoyance.

4. Record the escalation levels: tier 1 for first-line resolution, tier 2 for specialist support and tier 3 for vendor or engineering, and state what justifies each escalation.
5. Write a complete ticket for the scenario: a user reports that their laptop will not connect to the office Wi-Fi since returning from leave, while their phone connects normally.
6. Record the diagnostic steps in the ticket in the order you performed them, including the ones that ruled a cause out, because a negative result is evidence.
7. Record the resolution in language a colleague could act on without speaking to you, naming the specific setting or component changed.
8. Review your ticket against the professional writing rules: clear and concise, no jargon or slang, no blame directed at the user, and factual throughout.
9. Record the documentation types an organisation maintains: acceptable use policy, network topology diagram, standard operating procedures, new-user setup checklist, end-user termination checklist, incident reports and knowledge base articles.
10. Explain what an acceptable use policy governs and why every user must acknowledge it before being granted access.
11. Convert the resolved ticket into a knowledge base article with a searchable title, a symptom section, a cause section, a numbered resolution and a prevention note.
12. Record the test of a good knowledge base article: a tier 1 technician who has never seen the problem can resolve it from the article alone, with no further questions.

Test it — verification

Your ticket contains all nine required fields with a justified severity and escalation level; the diagnostic steps include at least one that ruled a cause out; and the knowledge base article has a searchable title, symptom, cause, numbered resolution and prevention note.

Troubleshooting this lab

Symptom	What to check
A command returns "command not found"	Re-run the <code>apt-get install</code> step at the start of the lab — the playground starts with a minimal package set.
The Killercoda terminal has reset	The playground times out when idle. Reopen it and re-run the setup commands from step 1.
A browser tool will not load	Check the URL against <code>labs/tools.md</code> . All four tools run entirely client-side and need no login.

Symptom	What to check
Output differs from the guide	Record what you actually observed — your environment differs from the reference, and explaining the difference is part of the exercise.

Review questions

1. State the exam objective this lab maps to, in your own words.
2. Which single step in this lab would you perform first on a real support call, and why?
3. What evidence would you attach to a support ticket to show this work was completed correctly?
4. Name one thing that would make this procedure fail, and how you would recognise it.

Record your evidence

Complete worksheet.md as you work through this lab and keep it — the Practical Performance assessment mirrors these tasks.

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